



From Prisoner to PhD

【BBC科普精选：从囚徒到PhD，不一样的人生】

Summary: Stephen Aquarita Vintaski shares his transformative journey from being a prisoner sentenced to 16 years for drug dealing to becoming a PhD holder working with incarcerated students. He recounts how the death of his father during his teenage years led him down a path of crime, but discovering education in prison gave him hope and purpose. Despite initial self-doubt and skepticism from other prisoners, he earned multiple degrees while serving his sentence. Now working as a lecturer in prisons, he emphasizes that everyone has the potential to change through education, challenging societal perceptions about prisoners and advocating for rehabilitation over pure punishment.

摘要：斯蒂芬·阿夸里塔·文塔斯基分享了他从因贩毒被判16年监禁的囚犯转变为与囚犯学生打交道的博士的蜕变历程。他回忆了少年时期父亲去世如何使他走上犯罪道路，但在狱中发现教育给了他希望和目标。尽管最初自我怀疑并遭到其他囚犯的质疑，他在服刑期间获得了多个学位。如今作为监狱讲师，他强调每个人都有通过教育改变的潜力，挑战社会对囚犯的看法，并倡导以改造为主而非单纯惩罚。





🕒 Estimated Reading Time: 6 min.

📖 四级生词 📖 六级生词 📖 雅思生词 📖 托福生词 📖 专八生词 📖 SAT生词 📖 考研生词 📖 GRE生词

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▶ Prisoner, PhD, the job dealer, father, each of these words conjures up a different picture.

囚徒、博士、职业#中介#、父亲，每个词都勾勒出不同的画面。

▶ None of them tells you exactly who someone is.

它们都无法准确告诉你一个人究竟是谁。

▶ My name is Stephen Aquarita Vintaski.

我的名字是斯蒂芬·阿夸里塔·文塔斯基。

▶ My PhD candidates and an electric number to me, really open university.

我的博士生们和一个对我来说意义非凡的号码，真正开启了大学之路。

▶ I work with students in prison.

我在监狱里与学生们一起工作。

▶ I love what I do.

我热爱我的工作。

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▶ It feels deeply personal to me because I used to be a prisoner too.

这对我而言意义深远，因为我也曾是一名囚犯。

▶ All of these levels have been mine.

所有这些身份我都曾经历过。

▶ So growing up, life was tough.

所以成长过程中，生活很艰难。

▶ My father died in the car crash when I was a teenager and that hit me really hard.

我的父亲在我#青少年#时期死于车祸，这对我打击沉重。

▶ I didn't see the world as a meritocracy.

我不认为世界是任人唯贤的。

▶ I had to grab what I could.

我只能抓住我能得到的一切。

▶ But being a center prison for dealing drugs was a shock.

但因贩毒被关进中心监狱令人震惊。

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▶ I was sentenced to 16 years.

我被判了16年徒刑。

▶ For the first three months inside, I didn't speak to anyone.

入狱头三个月，我没和任何人说过话。

▶ Eventually, I started working in the kitchen and as people got to know me, I was eventually assessed for my educational potential and encouraged after that assessment to enroll at the Open University.

后来我开始在厨房工作，随着大家逐渐了解我，最终接受了教育潜力评估，并在评估后受鼓励报名开放大学。

▶ But the most difficult barrier was actually inside of me.

但最难的障碍其实在我内心。

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▶ I'd left school with no qualifications.

我离开学校时没有任何学历。

▶ Nothing, I was scared of my future and I decided to try.

一无所有，我对未来感到恐惧，于是决定尝试。

▶ My day job, working in the kitchen, seven and a serving, meant that I had to study at night, so I had to study my toilet while myself being small.

白天在厨房工作七小时兼送餐，意味着我只能夜间学习，只得在狭小空间里借着厕所灯光苦读。

▶ So when I finished my first module, he gave me hope and he gave me something I could focus on that was not going back now.

所以当我完成第一个模块时，它给了我希望，给了我值得专注的目标——不再回头。

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▶ Other prisoners and gags kept asking me why I was wasting my time.

其他囚犯和狱警不停问我为何浪费时间。

▶ Studying wouldn't matter with my criminal record.

有犯罪记录读书也无用。

▶ I thought I was changing.

但我感觉自己正在改变。

▶ I discovered I loved learning and that was enough to keep me going.

我发现我热爱学习，这便足以让我坚持下去。

▶ I served eight years of my 16-year sentence.

16年刑期我服了8年。

▶ By the time I left prison, I had completed my first degree and I had also completed two further degrees master's level.

出狱时，我已完成第一个学位和两个硕士级深造学位。

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▶ So after I was released, I got to job working with students in prisons, not in spite of who I was, but because of it.

获释后我得到监狱教学工作，不因过往身份受阻，反因其受益。

▶ I had to describe how I felt the first time I went back to prison as a lecturer and the government has come down and shoot my head.

首次以讲师身份回到监狱时，那种感受难以言表——仿佛政府突然降临对准我的脑袋开枪。

▶ What I want people to know is that I'm not different or special.

我想让人们明白，我并无非凡之处。

▶ Anybody can do this.

任何人都能做到。

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▶ Almost half of all prisoners have left school without achieving any formal qualification.

近半囚犯离校时未获得任何正式学历。

▶ I know that feels and I had a massive impact in my confidence.

我深知那种感受，它曾重创我的自信。

▶ But that does not mean that you're not able to learn.

但这不意味着你无法学习。

▶ Everyone has the potential and the power to change.

每个人都有改变的潜力与力量。

▶ I've seen it and I've lived it.

我亲眼见证，也亲身经历。

▶ There was Winston Churchill who said, there is treasure if you can only find it in the heart of every man.

温斯顿·丘吉尔曾说，每个人心中都藏有#珍宝#，只要你愿意发现。

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▶ What do we want from our prisons?

我们对监狱有何期待？

▶ Is the primary goal of prisons punish or to help find a different path?

监狱的首要目标是惩罚，还是助人寻得新生之路？

▶ The policies in coherent, you see?

政策需要#连贯性#，明白吗？

▶ Research shows that education does reduce real fending.

研究表明教育确实能减少再犯。

▶ It allows former prisoners to make different choices.

它让刑满释放者能做出不同选择。

▶ So when I see new prisoners, I say to them, I wasn't even choose.

所以见到新入狱者时，我会说：我当初别无选择。

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▶ But I am now released outside, got a good job, got a good life, and with my family.

但如今我获释在外，拥有好工作、好生活，与家人团聚。

▶ Had I met somebody like me, well, I was younger, I think it might have been very different.

若年轻时遇到像我这样的人，人生或许会大不相同。

▶ No one believed in me.

当时无人相信我。

▶ I didn't believe in myself either.

我也不相信自己。

▶ It's taken two decades to get here.

走到今天花了二十年光阴。

▶ And this is only the beginning.

而这仅是个开端。

▶ The world prisoner is just a label.

“囚犯”不过是个标签。

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▶ I found freedom within my own mind.

我在内心找到了自由。

▶ You need to remember that you have the capacity to learn.

你需要记住自己拥有学习的能力。

▶ You have the capacity to change your life.

你拥有改变人生的力量。

 There is treasure within each and every one of us.

我们每个人心中都藏有#珍宝#。

